Installing and getting started with Node.js

Node.js is a platform for executing JavaScript in an event-driven environment so you can easily build network applications. To install Node.js, visit https://nodejs.org and download the package that fits your OS. All examples in this book are tested with Node.js 14.

After Node.js is installed, you can verify that everything works by typing `node --version` into your terminal. Your terminal should respond with something similar to `v14.*`. Now you're ready to run JavaScript examples like nodetodo for AWS.

Do you want to learn more about Node.js? We recommend *Node.js in Action* (second edition) by Alex Young, et al. (Manning, 2017), or the video course *Node.js in Motion* by PJ Evans (Manning, 2018).

To get started with Node.js and docopt, you need some magic lines to load all the dependencies and do some configuration work. Listing 12.3 shows how this can be done.

Where is the code located?

As usual, you'll find the code in the book's code repository on GitHub: https://github.com/AWSinAction/code3. nodetodo is located in /chapter12/. Switch to that directory, and run `npm install` in your terminal to install all needed dependencies.

Docopt is responsible for reading all the arguments passed to the process. It returns a JavaScript object, where the arguments are mapped to the parameters in the CLI description.

Listing 12.3 nodetodo: Using docopt in Node.js (index.js)